

First Read

Global Battery Supply Chain

Korean LFP cathode supply chain build accelerates

What's new?

[Reports](#) indicate Posco Future M has signed a 2027-30 supply agreement for 190,000 tons (~86 GWh) of LFP cathode material with a Korean battery maker.

Implications:

Korean battery makers are converting existing North America NCM EV capacity to LFP to serve the AIDC-driven [BESS supercycle](#). We estimate LGES and Samsung SDI's cumulative 2027-30 LFP battery volume at ~430 GWh and can already identify ~135 GWh of corresponding LFP cathode supply contracts with Korean cathode producers.

To qualify for the Production Tax Credit (PTC), US battery production must limit Chinese content (maximum 35% in 2027, falling to 15% by 2030). Korean cell makers initially favoured LFP cathode from overseas Chinese entities structured to avoid Foreign Entity of Concern (FEOC) designation. They are now increasingly de-risking by signing direct agreements with Korean cathode makers.

Korean LFP cathode capacity is still scaling and is likely to command a price premium to Chinese supply. These Korean capacities will also likely remain dependent on Chinese iron phosphate feedstock, creating residual full supply-chain "China-free" risk. We note companies such as [Sundeep Advanced Materials](#) are entering the LFP pre-cursor chain to help address this gap.

We remain broadly negative on Korean cathode makers due to their current portfolio concentration in oversupplied NCM, stretched balance sheets creating LFP funding challenges, and US policy dependence.

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Valuation Method and Risk Statement

Batteries have seen safety issues. This could negatively impact industry demand and/or individual companies in a recall scenario. Battery profitability and market share are sensitive to government policy including tariffs, sourcing rules and export controls.

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